

6.2 VLC Media Player

VLC media player started out as a student project at the École Centrale Paris. VideoLAN, the initial name of the project in 1996, was aimed at enabling the viewing of television on student PCs. The project led to the development of the VideoLAN Server and the VideoLAN Client (VLC). In 2001 it became an open source, cross-platform client for streaming server solutions.

VLC is a light player in terms of the setup file, disk space occupied, and also the RAM it uses while playing movies. VLC is also the most sought-after player, with downloads reaching more than two per second! It is robust and stable, and plays media files of almost any type one can think of. QuickTime, RealPlayer, and Windows



VLC plays practically anything
RealPlayer, and Windows

Media Player support their proprietary formats and also a few other common formats. For formats that are not common, and for proprietary format of other players, they require you to download and install a codec. VLC, on the other hand, has all the codecs required for playing even the rarest of media file formats. Add to this its cross-platform nature—it also works on Linux and Mac OS X—and you can see why VLC is called by many the best player around.

File types supported include MPEG1, MPEG2, MPEG4, .iso, .dcmp, .flv, .3gp, and .ogg, which is not a comprehensive list in the least! VLC can also capture unicast (communication between a single sender and a single receiver on a network) and multicast (communication between a single sender and multiple receivers)